

Yangxu Lin

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Personal statement

Yangxu is currently a Research Assistant at the University of Oxford's Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI) and holds an MSc in Economics for Development from the University of Oxford's Department of Economics and the Oxford Department of International Development (ODID).

Her primary research focuses on social interventions that improve child and adolescent wellbeing in Africa, with interests in cash transfer programmes and community health workers. More broadly, she is interested in labour markets, firms, and industrial policy. At Oxford, she works with the [Accelerate Research Hub](#) and collaborates with global partners including UNICEF, the Gates Foundation, as well as NGOs and government ministries in Ethiopia.

Professionally, Yangxu has contributed to several high-impact investment case studies. She led the costing analysis for an investment case on child marriage in Ethiopia, contributed to a child marriage investment case in Northern Nigeria, and led the quantitative modelling, return-on-investment analysis, and drafting for a WHO road safety investment case study in Tunisia. She has also worked on the economic evaluation of sugar-sweetened beverage tax in Thailand while serving in UNDP.

Academically, Yangxu is the first author of a systematic review with meta-analysis examining the role of community health workers in improving adolescent health and wellbeing in sub-Saharan Africa, currently under minor revision at the *Journal of Adolescent Health*. Her MSc dissertation at the University of Oxford investigated how climate change, including both contemporaneous environmental shocks and early-life climate exposure, affected child labour and educational outcomes. She is currently involved in four ongoing research projects with PhD students from the London School of Economics, the University of Oxford, the University of Cambridge, and the University of Bristol. These projects examine: (i) labour-market returns to schooling and learning in Ethiopia; (ii) the evidence of the effects of anticipatory cash transfers for climate shocks on child nutrition and food security in low- and middle-income countries; (iii) growth, institutions, and public goods in Indonesia; and (iv) artificial intelligence, robots, and industrial policy in Europe. Yangxu has strong expertise in causal inference, econometrics, evidence synthesis, and economic evaluation. She is passionate about applying rigorous empirical methods to address policy-relevant questions in economics, public policy, and international development.

Outside academia, Yangxu is committed to community engagement and social impact. In China, she volunteered with the Changcheng Love Camp in her hometown for four years. She has also served as a mentor to a refugee in Burundi seeking admission to graduate study in the UK. She currently serves on the Events Team of the MIT Club of Great Britain, helping to organise Sloan alumni events across the UK.

Appointments

University of Oxford (Oxford)

Research Assistant, Department of Social Policy and Intervention
2024-Present

Previous

Appointments

R-Health Consult (Remote)

Intern Economist
2023

UNDP – HIV, Health, and Development Unit (Remote)

United Nations Volunteer

2023

ZS Associates (Shanghai)

Part-time Associate in Healthcare Consulting

2022

Ipsos (Shanghai)

Full-time Social Intelligence & Analytics Intern

2022

China Securities (Beijing)

Investment Banking Intern

2021

Education

University of Oxford

MSc in Economics for Development 2023-2024

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (XJTLU)

BSc in Economics, 2017-2021

University of Liverpool (awarded upon completion of studies at XJTLU)

BSc in Economics, 2017-2021

Credential

MIT (via MITx Online)

[MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy, 2023](#)

Research Grants, fellowships, and studentships

- 2024 St Hugh's College (Oxford) Alumni Grant Fund for research on labour market in Africa £750
- 2024 St Hugh's College (Oxford) Barbinder Watson Fund for conference travel £250
- 2020 XJTLU BSc Economics: Academic Excellence Award Scholarship RMB10,000
- 2019 XJTLU BSc Economics: Academic Excellence Award Scholarship RMB10,000
- 2018 XJTLU BSc Economics: Academic Excellence Award Scholarship RMB10,000

Policy documents

1. UNICEF. Harnessing Community Health Workers to Improve Adolescent Health and Well-being in Africa. 2025. Available online [here](#).

Manuscripts under review, working papers, and work-in-progress

1. **Lin Y**, Adesina O, Asuma BS, Chen-Charles J, Chalasani S, Cluver Lucie, Rudgard WE (Corresponding author). Community-health workers and adolescents' health and wellbeing across sub-Saharan Africa: A systematic review. Under revise and resubmit at *Journal of Adolescent Health*. Preprint available at medRxiv: [10.1101/2025.09.26.25336574](https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.09.26.25336574)
2. Mwala D, **Lin Y**, Cluver L. A systematic review of the effect of climate-related anticipatory cash transfers on household food security and child nutrition outcomes in low- and middle-income countries. Protocol available at PROSPERO: <https://www.crd.york.ac.uk/PROSPERO/view/CRD420261352532>
3. **Lin Y**, Bandyopadhyay R, Rudgard WE. Returns to literacy and numeracy: evidence from Ethiopia.
4. Teng D, **Lin Y (Corresponding author)**. Where do robots create skilled jobs: evidence from European talent flows.

5. **Lin Y.** Climate change and child labour: evidence from Ethiopia. Oxford MSc Economics dissertation (Merit)
6. **Lin Y.** The relative merit of conditional and unconditional cash transfers. Oxford term essay (Distinction).
7. **Lin Y.** Foreign direct investment, domestic investment, and economic performance: evidence from China. XJTLU BSc Economics dissertation (85%, top 5 papers across the business school).
8. **Lin Y.** A path of development for resource-rich and capital-scarce African countries. Oxford MSc Economics application writing sample.
9. **Lin Y.** Is a rise in world oil price a blessing or a curse for Nigeria in terms of manufacturing output? XJTLU term essay (92%, rank 1st).
10. **Lin Y.** Public goods game and punitive mechanisms. XJTLU term essay (96%, rank 1st).

Prizes and awards

International Business School Suzhou (IBSS), XJTLU

1. Prize of Best Overall Academic Performance in BSc Economics, 2021
2. First-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence (rank 1st in BSc Economics in AY2019-20), 2020
3. First-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence (rank 1st in BSc Economics in AY2018-19), 2019
4. First-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence (rank 1st in BA International Business in AY2017-18), 2019

Jiangsu Province, China

1. Merit-Based Outstanding Student, Bureau of Education in Jiangsu Province, China, 2018

Knowledge translation and public engagement

2025

- *Centre for Evidence-Based Interventions at DSPI, University of Oxford*, Presenter, November
- *Accelerate Research Hub Research-in-Progress Meeting*, Presenter, November

2024

- *Model WTO Conference on Subsidies and Environment*, Head Country Delegate of Bangladesh, March

2018

- *Model APEC Conference on MSMEs in Digital Era*, Delegate of Brunei Economy, May

Voluntary services

- Event Team Member at MIT Club of Great Britain Sloan Alumni (2026-ongoing)
- Mentor at Refugee-Led Research Hub, University of Oxford (2024-2025)
- Volunteer at Changcheng Love Camp, Weihai City, China (2017-2021)
- Enactus World, XJTLU (2017-2018)

Language and software skills

	Spoken	Reading	Writing
English:	Proficient	Proficient	Proficient
Chinese:	Native	Native	Native

Software: Python, Stata, R, Excel, Matlab, SurveyCTO, NVivo, LaTeX, ArcGIS (learning)
